```
permit(
    principal in ACME::Service::"docs",
    action == Action::"doc:index",
    resource in ACME::Document
)
unless {
    // exception: never index documents classified as Legal
    resource.sensitivity == "Legal"
};
```

For ordinary documents, Cedar returned `allow`, and the indexing request was forwarded to Search. For legal documents, Cedar returned `deny`, and the sidecar blocked the request before it ever reached the Search service. If the Docs service product manager later determines that documents with a sensitivity of `HighValue` should also not be indexed, that decision can be reflected by simply updating the policy.

With that policy in place, a typical request from the Docs service might look like this:

- Principal: Docs service (workload identity) acting on behalf of Carol
- Action: `doc:index`
- Resource: Document(“CustCo-proposal”)
- Context: sensitivity = “Legal”, tenant = CustCo

Cedar evaluates this request against the policy and returns `deny` because the document’s sensitivity is marked `Legal`. This indexing request is blocked at the proxy and never reaches the Search service. Cedar denies `requests` for legal documents, blocking them at the proxy. All other documents are allowed and indexed normally.

This pattern established a zero-trust baseline within the cluster. Each hop was verified with a strong service identity, and Cedar approved every call before it was forwarded. Developers didn’t need to add new checks to their services; enforcement was handled automatically in the mesh. The trade-off was increased operational complexity, but for high-volume internal traffic, the advantages outweighed the drawbacks.